

MEETING NOTES

Rules and Policy Subcommittee Meeting

March 02, 2023

*Held remotely through remote participation on Zoom
Thursday, March 02, 2023 from 4:30 to 6:00 PM*

AGENDA

As approved by the school committee on January 24, 2022 (2022-5): The Rules and Policy Subcommittee will review The Bullying Prevention and Intervention Plan for recommended updates.

- Continued from the Rules & Policy Subcommittee Meeting held on December 06, 2022.

Attendance: Member Ruseau, Member Graham, Member McLaughlin (*absent for initial roll call*) - 2/0

Central Administration: Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Joan Bowen, Dr. Peter Cushing, Suzanne Galusi, Nicholas Tucci, Paul D'Alleva

Public Participants: Nicole Branley

Objective: What is the purpose of the document and what do we want the document to do?

- The document consists of 38 pages and contains a lot of change management language, multiple duplications and out-of-date content that is problematic for anyone attempting to read in its entirety.
- The document is 13 years old with an initial approval date of 2010, revised in October 2011, 2014 and most recently, November 2020.
- Actual Policy is written into the law.
- School committees are not typically writing implementation plans.
- The Attorney General has confirmed the document cannot be worked on collaboratively as a shared document.

“Open meeting law does not carve out an exemption to the definition of deliberation for discussion that does not result in a decision or a vote. Any communication among a quorum of a public body on matters that are pending, or will come before it and within the public body’s jurisdiction, is considered deliberation Public body members should not work on a shared document except for during a properly noticed meeting that is open to the public. Non-subsistent edits like proofreading for typos would be okay but reworking a policy would be considered deliberation.”

- Member Ruseau: will share the current policy visually and the subcommittee will address each line, page by page, to revise the existing document to create a new Policy Guidelines document.
- Member McLaughlin: requests that a draft of the document, with all edits recorded be preserved.

Pages 1-4

District Bullying and Cyberbullying Policy Guideline

- Recommendation for the removal of the paragraph that outlines the history of the Policy.
- Much of the Policy Guidelines is student focused but does not cover student/staff, staff/staff or staff/family bullying or harassment. This needs to be determined as to how to include it in new Policy Guidelines.
- Determine the legalities as to how to address violations of the policy for any student engaging in bullying or cyberbullying at a location, activity or program that is not school related or through the use of technology or electronic device that is not owned, leased or used by the school district
 - Have legal (Atty Howard Greenspan) provide guidance to determine what the scope of involvement the school is responsible for outside of school hours/days to also include transitions between school levels, how to handle bullying/conflict and what legal language to include in the New Policy Guidelines.
- Much of the document is dated in language and format and requires updating to bring it current for today's culture and climate.

Internet Safety

- Move to a resources webpage but not embedded in the policy

Resources

- The links are either incorrect or inactive.
- If this section can be deleted, it does not need to remain in the New Policy Guidelines.

Pages 12-18

MPS Health Education Scope & Sequence

- This section needs to be removed from the Policy Guidelines.

Page 19

Academic and Non-academic Activities

- This section needs to be removed from the Policy Guidelines.

Page 12 and Page 27

Definitions

- Format is different and requires review to eliminate duplication. Member Ruseau to address.

Pages 28-33

Bullying Investigation & Response Forms

- Forms to be moved out of the existing policy and added to another policy altogether.

Member McLaughlin:

- requests to receive the document following each meeting. Would like to have a working document, together within a 2 month deadline, to be presentable to the community before the end of the school year, with the understanding that the work could be evolving.

- Flow Chart in collaboration with Dr. Cushing to include the timeline, taking into consideration the amount of time required for investigation, etc
- Noted for: March 09, 2023, 7-9p Online Bullying Presentation

Member Graham:

- to update District Obligations and format at some point in time.

Member Ruseau:

- Clean existing version, with decisions from this meeting.
- Check on sections that are required in the law and delete unnecessary verbiage as noted in the document.
- Generate questions for Atty Howard Greenspan.
- Definition and Consolidation

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent:

- To speak with Atty Howard Greenspan regarding his participation in the next meeting..

Next meeting: Tuesday March 21, 2023, 4:30pm - 6:00pm

Motion to adjourn by Member McLaughlin, 2nd by Member Graham - 3/0

MEETING ADJOURNED: 6:30 PM